

Pacifying Poison

Toh 795 · Derge Kangyur

དགྲ་ཞི་བར་བརྟེ་པ།

Pacifying Poison (Tibetan: duk zhiwar jepa) is a short dhāraṇī text that offers a protective formula for neutralizing the effects of poison. It opens with homage to a goddess of medicinal nectar, called the Stream of Wealth, and gives a brief mantra along with an invocation of the truth and splendor of the Buddha, by which poisons from nāgas, snakes, compounded substances, bites, roots, and fanged beasts are said to be vanquished. The text also gives practical instructions, such as reciting the formula over a leaf, flower, or fruit that is then given to another person, who will become delighted. The Sanskrit title is not evident from the material at hand. It is Toh 795 in the Kangyur, and belongs to the class of dhāraṇī and mantra texts, which are compact ritual formulas used for protection, healing, and other worldly aims.

...it will take effect. Having recited it over a leaf, a flower, or a fruit, whoever one gives it to will become delighted. The dhāraṇī for accomplishing the action is complete.

Pacifying Poison.

Homage to the goddess of medicinal nectar, the Stream of Wealth.

Tadyathā: Oṃ suru suru ka, vara vara ke, viri hiri, śuddhe viśuddhe svāhā.

By the truth of the Buddha, the Blessed One, and by his splendor, the poison of nāgas, the poison of snakes, the poison of compounded substances, the poison of bites, the poison of roots, and the poison of fanged beasts of prey are vanquished. One should say: "The poison is utterly vanquished."

The dhāraṇī for pacifying all poisons is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The opening fragment belongs to the preceding dhāraṇī, so its sense is partly lost. The mantra syllables are given in the Tibetan transcription with Sanskrit reconstructed, and they are not translated. The goddess's name, translated here as "Stream of Wealth," renders the Tibetan literally. The Sanskrit original is not securely recoverable from this passage. "Compounded substances" renders a term for poisons made by mixing ingredients, and "bites" renders a term whose exact sense, a poison from biting or from a contact bite, is somewhat uncertain.
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Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.